you don’t just have to deal with distances, but also need to factor in floors. Routers also normally come with a 4-port switch, which can come in handy in the future.

If you are going to connect, say, two systems, of which one is a desktop and the other is a laptop, and you will connect to the Internet using a dial-up account, then you need

1. A PCI wireless card supporting 802.11b/g

2. A PCMCIA wireless card if the laptop is not Centrino-based, or not Wi-Fi-ready supporting 802.11b/g

3. An Access Point supporting 802.11b/g

4. An RJ-45 network cable for connecting the access point to the desktop PC. (This cable is bundled with most of access points available in the market.)

If you are going to use DSL or cable internet with one desktop and laptop connected wirelessly, and you want to share the Internet connection on both, then you will need

1. A PCI wireless card supporting 8022.11b/g

2. A PCMCIA wireless card if the laptop is not Centrino-based, or not Wi-Fi ready supporting 802.11b/g

3. A wireless router with either a cable modem or a DSL modem inbuilt

If you are going to connect two systems that are not far away from each other, like two desktop PCs with fixed locations, then the Ad-Hoc mode is a very cost-effective solution. For this, you will need two wireless cards, and no access point or wireless router.